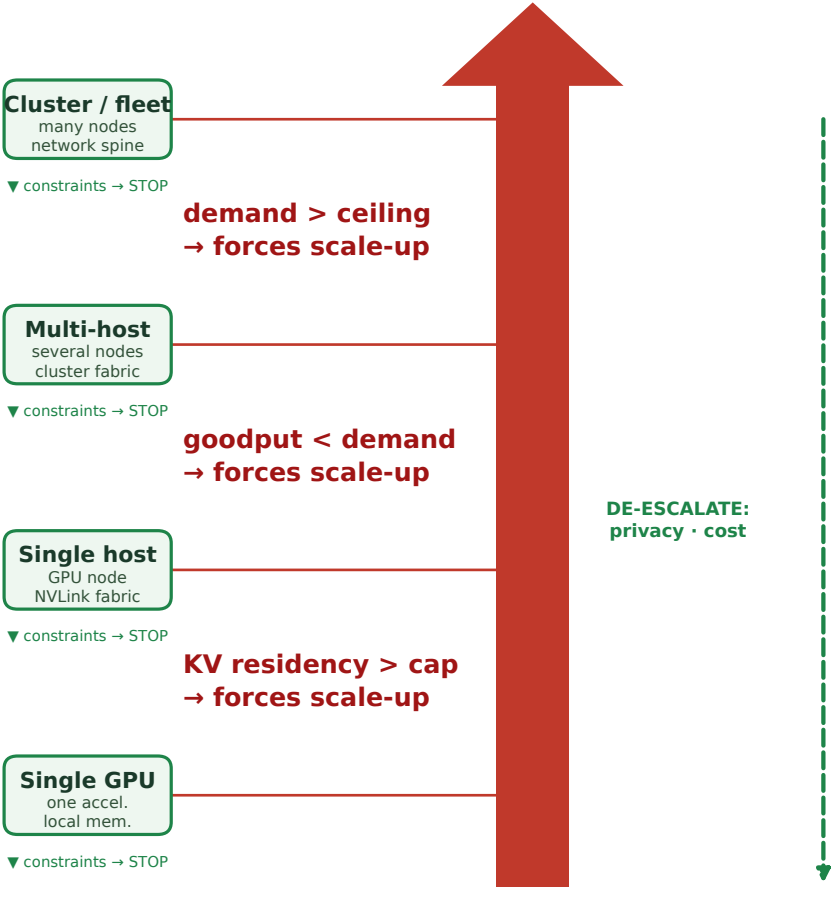
The reference-architecture escalation ladder



escalate only when a constraint binds — else STOP; tiers are orthogonal levels of scale, not a ranking